

Theme: Speech

Date: 2nd June, 2026.

Class: SS 1

Time: 8:40 - 9:20 am.

Period: 2nd.

Duration: 40 Min.

Subject: English Language

Week: 7

Unit Topic: Speech Work

Lesson Topic: Speaking to Persuade/Convince (Debate)

Specific (Behavioural) Objectives:

At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

1. explain the meaning of debate, and identify the features of persuasive speaking,
2. present logical arguments to support a position,
3. use appropriate expressions for persuading and convincing an audience,
4. participate effectively in a debate.

Instructional Resources:

Debate topic chart, flashcards containing persuasive expressions, whiteboard, marker.

LESSON PRESENTATION

Step 1: IDENTIFICATION OF PRIOR IDEAS

Mode: Individual

Teacher's Activities: Teacher asks students:

1. Have you ever convinced someone to agree with your opinion? How did you do it?
2. What strategies do speakers use to make people accept their point of view during an argument or discussion?
3. What is the difference between merely expressing an opinion and persuading others to accept it?
4. How can you use facts, examples, and logical reasons to convince your classmates that your position in a debate is correct?
5. Which argument in today's debate was the most convincing, and why did you find it persuasive?

Students' Activities: Students respond based on their experiences and prior knowledge.

Step 2: EXPLORATION

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities:

What is Debate?

A debate is a formal discussion in which two opposing sides present arguments for and against a motion in order to persuade an audience or judges.

What is Persuasive Speaking?

Persuasive speaking is the act of presenting ideas, facts, and arguments in a manner that convinces others to accept a viewpoint or take a particular action.

Students' Activities: Students listen attentively, repeat key points, and take notes.

Step 3: DISCUSSION

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities: Teacher explains the features of persuasive speaking and debate.

Features of Persuasive Speaking

- Clear statement of position.
- Logical arguments.
- Supporting facts and examples.
- Confidence and fluency.
- Appropriate voice projection.
- Respect for opposing views.
- Strong conclusion.

Useful Expressions for Persuasion

Introducing an Argument

- I strongly believe that...
- It is evident that...
- There is no doubt that...
- It is important to note that...
- I wish to state clearly that...

Giving Reasons

- Firstly,...
- Secondly,...
- Furthermore,...
- In addition,...
- Moreover,...

Refuting an Opponent's Argument

- My opponents failed to consider that...
- Contrary to their claim,...
- Their argument is misleading because...
- The facts clearly show that...
- I respectfully disagree with that position because...

Concluding a Debate

- In conclusion,...
- Based on the evidence presented,...
- Therefore,...
- For these reasons,...
- I urge you to support this motion.

Sample Debate Motion

"Social Media Does More Good Than Harm."

Proposition (For the Motion)

Social media promotes communication.

1. It provides educational resources.

2. It creates business opportunities.
3. It helps people stay informed.

Opposition (Against the Motion)

1. It encourages distraction among students.
2. It can spread false information.
3. It contributes to cyberbullying.
4. It may lead to addiction.

Students' Activities: Students identify persuasive expressions and contribute arguments on both sides.

Step 4: APPLICATION

Mode: Group Work

Teacher's Activities:

Class Activity Divide the class into two groups and assign the motion:

"School Uniforms Should Be Compulsory in Secondary Schools."

One group speaks for the motion while the other speaks against it.

Students' Activities: Students prepare and present arguments using persuasive expressions.

Step 5: EVALUATION

Mode: A Couple of Students

Teacher's Activities: Teacher asks students:

What is a debate?

1. What is persuasive speaking?
2. Mention five features of persuasive speaking.
3. State five expressions used in persuasion.
4. Present one argument for or against a given motion.

Students' Activities: Students respond orally and participate in a short debate session.

ASSIGNMENT

Write five arguments supporting and five arguments opposing the motion:
"Students Should Be Allowed to Use Mobile Phones in School."
Use at least five persuasive expressions in your presentation.

REFERENCE MATERIALS

F. Ademola-Adeoye et al. (2012). New Concept English for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 2. Learn Africa Plc, Lagos.
Oral English for Senior Secondary Schools.
WAEC and NECO English Language Recommended Texts.